PARTNERSHIP PROPOSAL

REIN Hubs × Academic City University

Building Africa's next climate-tech node — the first non-US capital channel toward the ACU Foundation's $10M 3-year goal

April 2026

PVBLIC Foundation · CleantechHUB · Academic City University (Accra)

Proposed unveil: CEEA 2026 Summit · 20–23 May 2026 · Accra

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ABOUT REIN HUBS

A Regional Entrepreneurship & Innovation Network

Four pillars — Resilience, Entrepreneurship, Innovation, Nature — wrapped around one mission: make climate-tech ventures fundable and scalable wherever they're born.

The Four Pillars

Letter	Pillar	Description
R	Resilience	Community-embedded models that withstand market and climate shocks.
E	Entrepreneurship	Founder-first programming across ideation → incubation → acceleration → growth.
I	Innovation	Frontier solutions in circular materials, clean energy, mobility, agriculture, water.
N	Nature	Environmental restoration and biodiversity as first-class outcomes, not side effects.

Key Facts

Metric	Value
Founded	2022 — PVBLIC Foundation × CleantechHUB initiative
Active hubs	5 — Colombia · Perú · Guatemala · Costa Rica · El Salvador
Entrepreneurs supported	100+ since inception
Program stages	Ideation → Incubation → Acceleration → Growth
Institutional partners	20+ (mentors, sponsors, ecosystem builders)
Global competition	ClimateLaunchpad — world's largest green startup competition

THE NETWORK

Five Active Hubs · One Proposed West African Node

REIN currently runs five hubs across Latin America. Academic City Accra would be the sixth — and the first in Africa.

Country	Status	Anchor Institution
Colombia	Active	Universidad Externado (Bogotá)
Perú	Active	Hub partner (Lima)
Guatemala	Active	Hub partner (Guatemala City)
Costa Rica	Active	Hub partner (San José)
El Salvador	Active	Hub partner (San Salvador)
Ghana (proposed)	**Proposed**	**Academic City University (Accra) · CCE Lab + Arm Lab + TEC**

THE ECOSYSTEM

Six Components That Make a REIN Hub Work

Corporate & Institutional

EU corporates, LatAm investors, university anchors, ecosystem builders — the capital, market access, and credibility layer.

Programme Mentors

200+ international industry leaders across cleantech, circular economy, deep tech, and impact finance.

Public–Private Match

Blended capital — grants, corporate sponsorship, equity — mirroring CCE's $2 private : $1 federal leverage.

Monitoring & Reporting

Unified venture tracking, impact metrics, and annual cohort reporting across the network.

University Anchors

Partner universities provide faculty, labs, students — anchoring the hub inside a durable academic institution.

Founder Peer Network

Cross-continent cohort exchanges, alumni network, and open events to plug founders into global climate-tech.

OPERATIONAL SUPPORT

Six Pillars of What Each Hub Gets

#	Pillar	Description
1	Branding	Co-branded identity, templates, and launch collateral — consistent REIN × local-anchor visual system.
2	Programming	Curated curriculum — ideation, incubation, acceleration — adapted to the local market and sector focus.
3	Mentorship	Access to 200+ international mentors, corporate partners, and alumni — matched to cohort needs.
4	Capital access	Connection to EU corporate sponsors, LatAm investor network, grant-writing support, and match funding.
5	Competition pathway	On-ramp to ClimateLaunchpad — national → regional → global finals (Singapore, October).
6	Shared infrastructure	Central ops, data, legal, and reporting — the hub focuses on founders, not overhead.

THE FINANCIALS

Per-Hub Budget & Four-Year Regional Envelope

Lean, transparent, and scaled for leverage — roughly $83K per hub per year, with a four-year regional envelope of $14.09M across 6 hubs.

Per-Hub Annual Budget ($83,000)

Line Item	Amount
Hub coordinator (full-time)	$32,000
Programming & curriculum delivery	$18,000
Founder stipends & cohort support	$12,000
Mentorship & expert network access	$8,000
Marketing, events, recruitment	$7,000
Shared ops contribution (central)	$6,000
Total per hub per year	**$83,000**

Four-Year Regional Envelope (6 Hubs)

Line Item	Amount
Hub operations (6 hubs × 4 years × $83K)	$1,992,000
Central ops, tech, data, legal	$2,400,000
Programme scale-up & new hub launches	$3,200,000
Capital-match channel (EU corporate, LatAm)	$4,500,000
ClimateLaunchpad regional + global	$1,200,000
Brand, comms, annual reporting	$800,000
Four-year total	**$14,092,000**

PROGRAMME PIPELINE

A Four-Stage Founder Journey

Stage	Name	Duration	Description
Stage 1	Ideation	2–3 weeks	Open call → screening. Problem-validation sprints, team-building, lean-canvas coaching.
Stage 2	Incubation	3 months	Structured curriculum, mentor matching, prototyping support, first customer conversations.
Stage 3	**Acceleration**	**6 months**	**GTM sprints, investor-readiness, ClimateLaunchpad entry, cross-continent cohort exchange.**
Stage 4	Growth	12+ months	Capital match, EU corporate offtake, alumni network, second-round fundraising support.

2026 CALENDAR

From Launch to Global Final

Date	Milestone	Description
Q1 2026	LatAm hubs open applications	All five Colombia/Perú/Guatemala/Costa Rica/El Salvador hubs open 2026 ClimateLaunchpad applications.
Apr 2026	Academic City proposal delivered	REIN × ACU proposal shared with Prof. McBagonluri + Foundation leadership.
May 20–23	**CEEA 2026 Summit · Partnership unveil**	**Partnership announcement at Academic City's Engineering Education for a Sustainable Future convening.**
3rd Week August	National Finals	Each hub selects its top performers for the regional final.
Sept 1–4	Regional Final	Best startups compete at regional level.
October 23	Global Final · Singapore	ClimateLaunchpad world championship.

A REIN × ACU partnership announcement at CEEA 2026 (20–23 May) positions the collaboration inside ACU's largest convening of the year and before the LatAm cohort cycle begins.

IMPACT

Proven Track Record

#	Metric	Detail
100+	Entrepreneurs	Supported across 5 countries since program inception
5	Active Hubs	Colombia · Perú · Guatemala · Costa Rica · El Salvador
4	Program Stages	Ideation → Incubation → Acceleration → Growth
20+	Institutional Partners	Mentors, sponsors, ecosystem builders
5+	Partner Universities	Including Universidad Externado (Colombia) · Academic City proposed
1	Global Competition	ClimateLaunchpad — world's largest green competition pathway

“Through REIN Hubs, we empower entrepreneurs across emerging markets to develop solutions that combat environmental challenges and generate economic impact in their communities.”

OUR PARTNER

Academic City University — Africa's STEAM Flagship in Accra

Academic City University (ACU) is a private STEAM-focused university in Accra, Ghana, founded in 2017 and awarded a Presidential Charter on 19 December 2024 — making it an independent degree-awarding institution. Ranked #2 in Ghana and #15 in Sub-Saharan Africa by Times Higher Education. ACU hosts Africa's first Sustainability Laboratory (the CCE Hub Ghana) plus the Arm Ecosystem Lab, both inaugurated 9 February 2023 in partnership with the US Department of State and Arm Ltd.

Organisation Profile

Field	Value
Founded	~2017 (formerly Academic City University College; charter granted 19 Dec 2024)
Campus	Property # 279-302, Agbogba, Haatso, P.O. Box AD 421, Accra, Ghana
Leadership	Prof. Fred McBagonluri (President & Provost) · Dr. Sena Agbodjah (VP Academic Affairs) · Ing. Dr. Lucy Agyepong (VP Institutional Advancement)
Accreditation	Ministry of Education · Ghana Tertiary Education Commission (GTEC) · Presidential Charter
Mission	Revolutionise higher education in Africa with a strong emphasis on STEAM + entrepreneurship; premier institution for project-based learning
2030 vision	Become a 'true academic city' impacting African education and innovation
Foundation	ACU Foundation · Chair Deepak Ahuja (CBO/CFO Zipline); board incl. Prof. Daniel Wubah (Millersville), Sarah McCarthy (Global Livingston), Noga Schechter (Silver Road Capital)
Foundation goal	$10M new funding over next 3 years · 30% scholarship target within 5 years
Recognition	Technovation 'Tech-driven Education Institution of the Year 2025' · 2026 WorldStar Global Packaging Award (Waakye Packaging) · Best HR in Education 2025

Six Labs & Initiatives

Category	Lab	Description
Anchor · Federal-backed	CCE Sustainability Lab	Africa's first Sustainability Laboratory · inaugurated 9 Feb 2023 · US State Department Connecting Climate Entrepreneurs (CCE) initiative · home of the Telesto Cl
Hardware	Arm Ecosystem Lab	Advanced robotics + digital fabrication; Arm-based hardware startups. Free tools + training for founders. Co-launched 9 Feb 2023 with Arm Ltd.
Prototyping	MakeLab ACity Accra	Open-access prototyping for youth entrepreneurship (with Embassy of Israel); SolidWorks training — the only regional university offering it for EV + mechatronics
Bioengineering	Bioinnovation Center	Affordable medical tech design in partnership with Northeastern University — cross-continental student–faculty research.
Umbrella	Technology & Entrepreneurship Center (TEC)	Runs the CCE Climate Tech Accelerator, CCE Hub, innovation sessions. Q3 2025: 140 youth trained · 73 workshops · 48% female participation.
Circular economy	Sustain City Project	Plastic-waste management + community buy-back; 100 recycled desks from 1M water sachets. Waakye Packaging Project won the 2026 WorldStar Global Packagi

Notable Alumni & Ventures

Entity	Type	Achievement
Goliath Robotics	Student venture	$80,000 Echoing Green grant · smart electronic wheelchair controllers (Barnabas Mawukley Nomo & Andrewla Ama Adoma Takyi)
Waakye Packaging Project	Student venture	2026 WorldStar Global Packaging Award — Sustainable Packaging
Farmio	CCE participant	Greenhouse farming solutions (Anaporka Adazabra) — US State Dept featured
Translight Solar / Transvolt Ghana	Alumnus-led	Solar + EV venture featured at Green Economy Innovation Session (Kobina Nyanteh)
Mana Mobility	Ecosystem partner	Electric-vehicle prototyping collaboration with ACU
Faith Sobe Cyril (Class of '24)	Alumna	Software Engineer, Apple UK
Elizabeth Fio (Class of '22)	Valedictorian	MS candidate, Worcester Polytechnic Institute

IMPACT AT SCALE

What Academic City Already Moves

Nearly a decade of proven results — a STEAM + cleantech pipeline ready to plug into REIN's Europe–LatAm network and the ACU Foundation's $10M / 3-year goal.

Metric	Value	Detail
Scholarships disbursed	$2M+	Cumulative since 2018 · on track to 30% of enrolment within 5 years
Student-led ventures	25+	Incubated on campus — from Goliath Robotics to Waakye Packaging
Graduate placement	98%	Alumni at Apple UK, Zipline, Turntabl, WPI, Apptronik, RGT
CCE 2023 entrepreneurs	17	Inaugural cohort of Telesto Climate Tech Accelerator — CCE global goal: 700 ventures + 500 students by 2026

CCE Hub & TEC Data

Signal	Value	Source
TEC Q3 2025 youth trained	140	TEC Newsletter 2025 Q3
TEC Q3 2025 workshops delivered	73	TEC Newsletter 2025 Q3
TEC female participation	48%	TEC Newsletter 2025 Q3
YALI West African Leadership Center — leaders trained (4-week program)	50+	CCE Hub Ghana Overview 2024
Sustain City output (since Nov 2021)	100 desks	10,000 water sachets each (~1M sachets recycled)
CCE public–private match ratio	**$2 : $1**	**Private : US Federal — the leverage model REIN mirrors in Europe/LatAm**

In December 2024, H.E. Nana Addo Dankwa Akufo-Addo granted Academic City the Presidential Charter — institutional stability no other emerging African STEAM university has. That charter is the foundation for long-term non-US capital partnerships.

STRATEGIC FIT

Diversifying the $10M Goal — Where ACU + REIN Compound

The ACU Foundation's three-year $10M target is anchored in US State Department capital. REIN brings the European and LatAm channel that diversifies it — without displacing the CCE relationship. Each side brings the half the other is missing.

What Academic City Contributes

- Africa's first CCE Sustainability Lab — a federally anchored, ready-made West African node
- Presidential Charter (19 Dec 2024) — independent degree authority + institutional stability
- Arm Ecosystem Lab — only regional university with SolidWorks training for EV + mechatronics
- First-in-Africa undergraduate AI + Robotics Engineering degrees — a pre-built hard-tech pipeline
- 17-entrepreneur CCE cohort infrastructure — proven accelerator delivery with Telesto + ANDE
- CEEA 2026 Summit (20–23 May, Accra) — largest West African engineering-education convening of the year
- 25+ nationalities on campus — pan-African + international student mix for cohort exchange
- Alumni at Apple UK, Zipline, Turntabl, Worcester Polytechnic — credible talent signal
- Proven project IP — Sustain City, Goliath Robotics ($80K Echoing Green), Waakye (WorldStar 2026)
- Ghana government alignment — Climate Envoy, VP, and Presidential endorsement

What REIN Hubs Contributes

- Non-US capital channel — European corporates + LatAm investor network directly feeding the Foundation's $10M 3-year goal
- LatAm founder pipeline from 5 active hubs into ACU's CCE Climate Tech Accelerator
- European corporate access — leverages ACU's existing WU Vienna + Fontys ties
- CleantechHUB accelerator programming — complements Telesto's 17-entrepreneur delivery
- ClimateLaunchpad on-ramp — continental scale-up pathway for CCE Hub alumni
- Public–private capital matching — mirrors CCE's $2:$1 model via European corporate network
- Cross-continent cohort exchange (Ghana ↔ LatAm), building on the ETHOS (Dayton) template
- Global marketplace integration for Sustain City, Waakye, and other circular-economy ventures
- Policy advocacy support on STEAM + entrepreneurship across West Africa
- Mentorship at scale — 200+ students/educators/year connected to international industry leaders

“We believe that the future is in our hands and that we must ensure its sustainability and equity.”

— Prof. Fred McBagonluri, President & Provost, Academic City University

MARKET CONTEXT

Ghana, West Africa & the Climate-Innovation Tailwind

Macro stability, a massive demographic dividend, and a structural cleantech demand signal (Galamsey, plastic waste, skilled-trades gap) converge. A non-US capital channel into ACU is the wedge to ride all three.

Headline Metrics

Indicator	Value	Implication
Ghana 2026 GDP growth	4.8%	IMF projection — recovery trajectory supports private cleantech capital deployment
Unfilled roles by 2030	2.1M	Projected skilled-trades gap across Africa — Arm Lab + TEC are the training answer
Plastic waste / year	8Mt	Ending up in water bodies globally — driver for Sustain City + Waakye Packaging
CCE leverage ratio	$2:$1	Private : US Federal — the exact match structure REIN mirrors with European corporate capital

Market Signals

Signal	Evidence	Implication
Ghana inflation (March 2026)	3.2%	Macro stability for multi-year capital commitments
Bank of Ghana Policy Rate (March 2026)	14.00%	Domestic debt cost — external capital premium valued
Africa workforce by 2030	Largest globally	Demographic dividend accessible through ACU's AI + Robotics pipeline
University ranking gap	Only 2 Ghanaian universities in THE's Sub-Saharan top 15	ACU's ambition to outsized share of West Africa's talent pipeline
Galamsey (illegal mining)	Persistent environmental degradation	Direct cleantech policy priority — aligns REIN with national agenda
CCE Hub global goal (by 2026)	700 market-ready climate ventures	REIN candidate cohort-volume gap between CCE Accra and global goal
CEEA 2026 Summit	**20–23 May 2026 · Academic City, Accra**	**Natural launch window for a REIN × ACU announcement**

Timing: ACU's Presidential Charter is 18 months old. Charter momentum + post-pandemic recovery + CEEA Summit + the $10M Foundation target form an open window. A partnership briefed now positions both sides to ride all four tailwinds.

THE VISION

REIN × Academic City Accra Hub — Unveiling at CEEA 2026

REIN × Academic City Accra Hub

Parameter	Detail
Partner host	Academic City University (Accra) — CCE Lab + Arm Lab + TEC
REIN side	PVBLIC Foundation · CleantechHUB
Focus sector	Climate-tech · circular materials · hardware & mechatronics · sustainable packaging
Cohort size	~10–15 startups per cycle (complementing CCE's 17-entrepreneur baseline)
Programs	Cross-continent cohort exchange · EU corporate offtake · co-branded cleantech track · capital-match channel
Mentors	ACU faculty + REIN international mentors + European corporate partners
Competition	ClimateLaunchpad Ghana → Regional → Global (Singapore)
$10M capital strategy	**REIN as non-US channel toward the ACU Foundation's 3-year target**

Phased Timeline

Date	Milestone	Detail
Apr 2026	Internal review + proposal delivery	Laurence Kalinsky (PVBLIC) reviews internally, then shares with Prof. McBagonluri — Makafui Awuku, Deepak Ahuja, Ursula Dussi on CC.
May 20–23, 2026	CEEA 2026 Summit unveil · Accra	Formal partnership announcement at Academic City's 'Engineering Education for a Sustainable Future' summit — highest-visibility West African engineering
Q2 2026	Letter of intent + MoU drafting	PVBLIC Foundation legal + ACU Foundation draft MoU; define capital-match commitments and workstream SOWs.
Q3 2026	Cohort scoping + first capital tranche	First cross-continent placement (LatAm founder into CCE Lab; ACU founder into LatAm hub). Initial European corporate commitment toward the $10M Fou
2027	Full REIN × ACU Accra programme	Co-branded cleantech track, capital-match channel active, offtake syndicate live — $2-private : $1-federal model mirrored in Europe.

NEXT STEPS

Moving Forward Together

Action Plan

#	Action	Who	When
1	Internal review of proposal	Laurence Kalinsky (PVBLIC) + Gideon Blaauw (CleantechHUB)	Apr 2026
2	Send proposal to ACU leadership	Laurence / Gideon → Prof. McBagonluri (CC Awuku, Ahuja, Dussi)	Late Apr 2026
3	Alignment call	Laurence + Gideon + McBagonluri + Awuku + Ahuja	Within 2 weeks
4	Partnership unveil	Joint announcement at CEEA 2026 Summit · Accra	May 20–23, 2026
5	Draft MoU + capital-match SOW	PVBLIC Foundation legal · ACU Foundation	Q2 2026
6	**Cohort scoping + first capital tranche**	**Full team**	**Q3 2026**

REIN Hubs Team

Name	Role	Email
Laurence Kalinsky	PVBLIC Foundation — REIN Hubs Lead	laurence@pvblic.org
Gideon Blaauw	CleantechHUB — Program Lead	gideon.blaauw@cleantechhub.net

Academic City Team

Name	Role	Email
Prof. Fred McBagonluri	President & Provost	info@acity.edu.gh
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Deepak Ahuja	Chair, ACU Foundation (CBO/CFO Zipline)	admin@acityfoundation.org

Together, we can make the REIN × Academic City Accra Hub the first non-US capital channel for Africa's federally anchored CCE ecosystem — and the anchor partnership toward the Foundation's $10M three-year goal.